

**Weak Two-bids**

Open 2♦, 2♥ or 2♠ with a 6-card suit headed by some honors and fewer 4-9 HCP.

Response of a new suit is not forcing. (Note: some pairs play this 1-round force)

Raise of Opener's suit is to play.

Response of 2NT is forcing and asks for further information.

After 2NT Response, Opener bids:

- 3 of original suit to show a weak hand

- 3 of another suit to show a good hand with high card in that suit

- 3NT with a suit of A K Q x x x

**Preemptive Bids**

An opening bid of 3 of any suit shows a 7-card suit and less than opening hand.

This is primarily a defensive bid, and you should be mindful of vulnerability, being more cautious when you are Vulnerable against Non-Vulnerable opponents. For these Deals assume neither side is Vulnerable.

As a rule of thumb, Responder should assume Opener can win six tricks and bid accordingly.

Board: 1  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 3♠  
Declarer: North  
Lead: ♦ J

Board: 2  
Dealer: **West**  
Contract: 3NT  
Declarer: East  
Lead: ♠ K

Board: 3  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 3NT  
Declarer: South  
Lead: ♣ K

Board: 4  
Dealer: **West**  
Contract: 4♠  
Declarer: West  
Lead: ♥ K

Board: 5  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 4♠  
Declarer: North  
Lead: ♦ 4

Board: 6  
Dealer: **East**  
Contract: 3♥  
Declarer: East  
Lead: ♠ A

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4  
 ♥ Q J 10  
 ♦ K 6 5  
 ♣ A J 10 8 3

♠ K Q 9 8 6 2

♥ 8 6 4

♦ 9 4

♣ K 6



♠ A 5  
 ♥ 9 7 2  
 ♦ J 10 8  
 ♣ Q 9 7 5 2

♠ J 10 3

♥ A K 5 3

♦ A Q 7 3 2

♣ 4

SOUTH has one of those hands which might or might not be helpful to NORTH. He needs more information about NORTH's hand, so he bids 2NT.

NORTH has a better than average hand, so she bids 3♣ to show a high card in the suit.

SOUTH was hoping for a high card in ♦s rather than ♣s, so he signs off in 3♠

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             | 2♠    | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass        | 3♣    | Pass | 3♠    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 3♠ by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦ J   |       |      |       |

**Board 2**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 7 3  
♥ K 5 3  
♦ K Q 10 8 7 2  
♣ 9 4

♠ J 9 8 2  
♥ 10 9 8 7  
♦ 6 5  
♣ Q 10 8



♠ A 6 4  
♥ Q 4 2  
♦ A J 4  
♣ A K 6 5

♠ K Q 10 5  
♥ A J 6  
♦ 9 3  
♣ J 7 3 2

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| 2♦          | Pass  | 2NT  | Pass  |
| 3♥          | Pass  | 3NT  |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 3NT by East |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠K    |       |      |       |

With four fast winners EAST should think about game. The best approach is usually to use 2NT to find out more about WEST's hand.

EAST found out that WEST has good opening strength, and, most importantly, either the ♥A or ♥K. Now that she doesn't have to worry about the opponents taking the first five ♥ tricks she bids 3NT.

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10  
♥ J 4 3 2  
♦ 10 8 7  
♣ K Q J 7

♠ 9 7 5

♥ 7 6

♦ A K Q 9 6 2

♣ 8 3



♠ J 6 4 3 2

♥ Q 10 9 5

♦ 5

♣ 9 4 2

♠ K Q 8

♥ A K 8

♦ J 4 3

♣ A 10 6 5

SOUTH is strong enough to be thinking about game, depending on how good NORTH's hand is. So he bids 2NT to get more information.

NORTH has the exact hand to say 3NT - a suit headed by AKQ.

Game (and bidding) doesn't get much easier.

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 2♦    | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣K     |       |      |       |

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 8 7 5 3

♥ 2

♦ 7 5 4

♣ J 5

♠ A

♥ K Q 6

♦ Q 9 6 2

♣ 10 8 7 4 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 10 9 2

♥ A 8 7 4 3

♦ 3

♣ A K 9 2

♠ 6 4

♥ J 10 9 5

♦ A K J 10 8

♣ Q 6

*West*

3 ♠

*North*

Pass

*East*

4 ♠

*South*

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥K

EAST assumes her partner can win six tricks. So she will need to contribute four more to make game.

Three of them are obvious, and she expects to get a ♦ ruff also.

**Board 5**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 3  
♥ A Q 10 6  
♦ K J 10 7  
♣ 10 9 3

♠ A K 8 7 6 2

♥ 8 3

♦ 8 3

♣ K 6 5



♠ J 5 4  
♥ K 9 4 2  
♦ Q 5 4 2  
♣ 8 7

♠ Q 9

♥ J 7 5

♦ A 9 6

♣ A Q J 4 2

NORTH's hand has the look of a Weak Two-bid, but it is one point too strong. So she opens 1 ♠.

SOUTH naturally bids 2 ♣ and NORTH rebids the ♠ suit.

SOUTH always knew there would be a game bid, so with an 8-card fit he bids 4 ♠

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1 ♠   | Pass | 2 ♣   |
| Pass         | 2 ♠   | Pass | 4 ♠   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 4 ♠ by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦ 4    |       |      |       |

**Board 6**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 8 3

♥ 10 6

♦ K J 4

♣ K Q J 4

♠ 10 7 4 2

♥ K 2

♦ Q 3 2

♣ A 10 8 7



♠ 6 5

♥ A Q J 8 7 5 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ 5

♠ A K 9

♥ 9 4

♦ A 10 8 6

♣ 9 6 3 2

WEST may have an opening hand, but it is just the wrong kind of hand to respond to partner's preemptive bid. She doesn't have the immediate winners that EAST is likely to need, but she is in good shape for defense should the opponents bid.

In other words, WEST has the perfect hand with which to pass.

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by East

Lead: ♠ A